

LITO ZARATE BIALA

HANDS-ON AI BUILDER & ENTERPRISE AI PRODUCT LEAD | AGENTIC ENGINEERING · MCP · INCIDENT MANAGEMENT · SITE RELIABILITY · AI STRATEGY

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SUMMARY

Hands-on AI builder and enterprise AI product lead at Wells Fargo: I build governed GenAI products end to end (problem framing, workflow design, implementation, evaluation suites, stakeholder adoption), backed by 12+ years of leadership across people management and technical delivery. I find the bottleneck that needs a foundational fix, build the AI that clears it, and make the system prove it worked. I'm at my best making hard technical topics land with any audience while shaping the AI strategy to fit the business case. Reliability-first AI grounded in human review, evidence provenance, observability, and enterprise risk. Public, CI-verified evaluation portfolio at github.com/LZBiala - the build fails if a published claim drifts.

AI LEADERSHIP & TECHNICAL STRENGTHS

- **AI Product & Strategy:** use-case discovery, roadmap sequencing, requirements, acceptance criteria, adoption, stakeholder alignment.
- **GenAI & Agentic Systems:** RAG, LLM evaluation frameworks and evals, prompt/context engineering, MCP integration, agents, human-in-the-loop controls.
- **AI Engineering Delivery:** Python, Streamlit, TypeScript, GitHub, CI/CD, automated tests, code review, iterative PR-based delivery.
- **Reliability & Governance:** SRE, incident management, 5-Why/RCA, MTTx, observability, fail-closed behavior, AI risk and compliance readiness.
- **Agentic Build Tooling:** Claude Code, Codex, Devin - daily hands-on agentic system delivery with human-in-the-loop controls.

PUBLIC AI EVALUATION & RELIABILITY PORTFOLIO - [GITHUB.COM/LZBIALA](https://github.com/LZBiala) · [LZBIALA.GITHUB.IO](https://lzbiala.github.io)

- **wiki-memory-lab:** agent-memory evaluation framework; selective recall at 0.61x the tokens of the full-context baseline, with the loss trade-off (1.27x) measured and published rather than hidden.
- **agent-mutation-lab:** behavioral defect-detection harness; caught 9/10 planted defects with 0 false alarms on byte-identical clean controls; best-of-k voting study where panel accuracy tracks the exact binomial (Condorcet) prediction, with published controls showing when voting cannot help.
- **adversarial-chambers:** proposer, skeptic, and judge evals with no role played twice; instruction-flip test - a scripted evidence-driven judge flips 0/8 verdicts, a scripted deferential judge flips 3/8, exactly the ambiguous items.
- **memory-repair-lab:** placebo-controlled self-repair evaluation; 8/10 → 10/10 on a held-out split sealed before generation zero.

All four are CI-verified on Windows and Linux: the build fails if any published claim drifts from regenerated data. Each ships an interactive walkthrough a stakeholder can click through.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Vice President, Lead Digital Product Service Manager | Wells Fargo, Digital Technology & Innovation

Individual-contributor leadership role · Minneapolis, MN | Feb 2025 - Present

- **AI product delivery:** lead delivery of two governed AI products (an incident-notification quality assistant and a Daily 5-Why QA platform), turning operational bottlenecks into buildable specs: requirements, evidence-source rules, versioned scoring rubrics, and acceptance tests, all gated by human review and grounded in SRE and DevOps best practices.
- **Hands-on build:** daily engineering with GitHub, Jira, Devin, VS Code Copilot, Python, Codex, and Claude Code - focused branches, pull requests, automated tests, coverage, linting, type checks, and protected-file audits for reviewable change.
- **Evidence architecture:** designed the evidence architecture pulling live incident and RCA data from ServiceNow and SharePoint: every record carries its provenance and passes schema validation; the system redacts diagnostics, fails closed on bad data, and requires explicit approval gates before touching production.
- **Responsible-AI boundaries:** established product boundaries that removed person-level scoring and identity from published score-bearing outputs - keeping names only for routing work to the right team and supporting 24-hour handoffs across global time zones.
- **Incident leadership:** lead major-incident, vulnerability-remediation, and operating-review readiness across distributed stakeholders; translate technical evidence into decision-ready impact, root-cause, detection-gap, mitigation, and preventive-action narratives. Years managing an API gateway platform made me the connective layer between Product, AppDev, DevOps, and governance.

- **AI enablement:** advance AI adoption through executive communication, pair programming, prompt-engineering enablement, technical documentation, and coaching on responsible human-in-the-loop delivery.

Senior Assistant Vice President, Digital Product Service Manager | Wells Fargo

Minneapolis, MN | Oct 2022 - Feb 2025

- **Reliability:** improved resiliency and uptime for customer-critical applications; reduced incident response times (MTTx) through proactive engineering, 5-why root-cause discipline, and DevOps practice.
- **Observability:** enhanced log-based alerting and monitoring through platform migrations (Splunk, Grafana), preserving operational continuity with executive-level service-health insight.
- **Platform delivery:** engineered foundational platforms for scale through cloud migration and data-center exit; led engineering release meetings across AppDev, Platform, and Product teams via CI/CD; guided distributed US/India engineering teams.

Senior Technology Business Systems Consultant | Wells Fargo, Digital Technology & Innovation

Jan 2022 - Oct 2022

- Kept digital information systems running smoothly under SRE, ITIL, and ITSM best practices; supported incident and problem management for production applications.

Software Product Analyst | Wells Fargo, Strategy, Digital & Innovation

Mar 2021 - Jan 2022

- Monitored health and status of internal APIs through dashboards and data solutions; analyzed historical trends to surface persistent performance issues.

Earlier people-leadership and operations roles - full history on LinkedIn.

TECHNOLOGY

AI/ML: Generative AI, RAG, agentic automation, LLM evaluation frameworks, prompt optimization, responsible AI, MCP, knowledge graphs, wiki-based agent long-term memory · **Engineering:** Python, Streamlit, TypeScript, Git, GitHub, APIs, CI/CD, automated testing · **Operations:** Splunk, Grafana, observability, incident/problem management, 5-Why RCA, MTTx, ITIL · **Leadership:** AI product strategy, distributed-team leadership, technical writing, executive communication, risk and compliance · **Agentic tooling:** Claude Code, Codex, Devin (Cognition)

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

Data Analytics & Data Visualization Boot Camp Certificate, University of Minnesota Twin Cities · B.A. Psychology, Metropolitan State University

Splunk courses: Fundamentals 1-3 & Cloud Observability · Anthropic Academy course completions, 2026: Claude Code in Action · Introduction to Model Context Protocol · Wells Fargo internal SRE-leadership and AI-engineering program pathways